Unit 1: Skills, culture and phonics

💡 **Big idea:** We read about **unusual schools around the world** and **Maryam's diary** about her first day. We learn to **make arrangements**, write about our **favourite lesson**, and say the sounds **y, ie, igh, i_e** (pie, night, kite, fly).

🎯 **I will learn:**

- Read about unusual schools
- Read and understand a diary
- Make arrangements: Do you want to...?
- Write about my favourite lesson
- Say the long i sound: y, ie, igh, i_e

📖 Key words

unusual غير عادي	**flood** فيضان	**outdoor** في الهواء الطلق	**boarding school** مدرسة داخلية
diary مذكرات يومية	**worried** قلق	**free** غير مشغول	**arrange** يرتّب موعدًا

Unusual schools around the world

- In **Bangladesh** there are sometimes floods, so some children study at school **on a boat**
- In **Indonesia** a school teaches children using examples from **nature**
- In **the USA** one school never uses books or paper
- children use **computers**
- In **Britain** some schools have an **outdoor lesson** once a week (Forest School)
- Fun fact: at a **boarding school** children sleep at school on weekdays

Maryam's diary

- Saturday: I feel **worried**. Tomorrow is my first day in Grade 4 at a new school.
- Sunday morning: I'm awake early because I'm so nervous.
- Sunday afternoon: The children are friendly and I've got a new friend, **Muna**.
- Monday: The Art lesson is great. My picture is on the wall! I think this school is going to be OK for me.

English in action: making arrangements

- **Do you want to** play football tomorrow morning?
- **Sorry, I can't.** / I'm not free.
- **What about** Saturday?
- **Let's meet** at quarter to five in the park. See you then!

Writing and phonics

- My favourite lesson is English. I like it because we play games. I also like Maths.
- Use a **capital letter** at the start of each sentence and for subject names, and a **full stop** at the end
- Phonics (long i): **ie** pie, **igh** night, **i_e** kite, **y** fly, shy
- Tongue twister: Every **night**, I eat a **pie** and **fly** a **kite**.



The long i sound: ie (pie), igh (night), i_e (kite)

✏️ Examples

Why do some children in Bangladesh study on a boat?

Answer: Because there are sometimes floods.

How does Maryam feel at the end?

Answer: Happy. She makes a friend and enjoys her Art lesson.

Your friend says: Do you want to play on Friday? You're busy.

Answer: Sorry, I can't. What about Saturday?

⭐ Remember

- In a diary write the day and date, and say how you feel

🧩 **Activity:** Make a poster about your perfect school

✅ Check yourself

1. Where do children study on a boat?
2. Who is Maryam's new friend?
3. Which letters say i in "night"?
4. Complete: Let's ___ at five.

Answers: (1) Bangladesh ، (2) Muna ، (3) igh ، (4) meet